

**Amazon Healthcare**

Amazon acquires another healthcare start-up for its Amazon Care program. <https://dgit.in/nov19-09>

**Randori Recon**

Boston-based startup Randori's Randori Recon acts like a hacker to reveal your weaknesses. <https://dgit.in/nov19-10>



Ready yourself for a more inclusive future of gadgets and technologies aimed towards the disabled

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hile the average Joe often tends to take the 'connected' lives we live, in today's technologically-accelerated world, for granted, those with disabilities have never had it easy when it comes to this. This market is no niche market either. According to WHO's World Report on Disability, around 15 per cent of the entire world's population is disabled, which amounts to over a billion people. The demographic is extensive and their inclusion into the world of technology is imperative to make them more empowered than they already are.

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However, it may be often seen, especially in developing or under-developed nations, that people with disabilities often shy away from gadgets and other tech products simply because of the lack of usability. According to Pew Research, 20 per cent of disabled people don't own a computer, smartphone or tablet. Fortunately, tech startups, as well as behemoths, are increasingly making an effort to change that.

With the power of modern-day technology such as machine learning and AI as well as the decreasing cost of hardware, tech companies are now enabled to craft assistive technology and build accessibility services onto their devices. These companies have also begun recognising the financial potential of the market, as devices equipped with assistive technologies will ultimately be sold more widely.

ROLE OF THE TECH GIANTS

Over the last few years, tech giants such as Google, Facebook and Apple have begun working towards making their products and services more approachable to those with disabili-

ties, such as those who struggle with mobility, sight, hearing or speech.

Microsoft and Google conjointly offer a total of \$45 million in grants to developers of assistant tech. Additionally, legislation on a national and international front has also compelled companies to implement web accessibility standards onto their services. Here are some tech giants that are working towards making tech more accessible to those with disabilities.

FACEBOOK

In 2011, the social behemoth Facebook formed its Accessibility Team with the goal of catering to people with disabilities. Since then, there have been numerous improvements made to the accessibility of the social media platform such as the game-changing photo description system. So, instead of screen readers interpreting an image as something as unhelpful as 'photo' or '237ABCD.jpg', users will actually be provided with descriptions of the photos. When this feature was first introduced, it was rather rough around the edges and could only